

Project Charter: Data Center Construction & Help Desk Software Implementation

Project Title

Hybrid Infrastructure & IT Modernization Initiative

Project Purpose / Justification

This project aims to establish a secure, scalable data center to serve as the core infrastructure for a new organization-wide help desk system. This initiative is driven by the need for enhanced service reliability, operational security, and centralized support infrastructure.

High-Level Goals / Objectives

1. **Construct a fully operational Tier II/III Data Center** in 10 months, ready for production load.
 2. **Deploy and launch Agile-based Help Desk Software** over 6 months, starting in parallel with construction at Month 6.
 3. Ensure seamless production readiness with **1-month buffer post-construction** before Go-Live.
 4. Meet compliance, redundancy, and physical security standards for enterprise-level IT infrastructure.
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Project Scope

In-Scope

Data Center Build:

- Concrete foundation & structural steel frame
- Brickwork, roofing, HVAC, and insulation
- Electrical and plumbing installation
- Network infrastructure: internet/phone cabling, data rack install
- Interior build-out for equipment zones, breakrooms, restrooms

- Fire suppression system
- Security: fencing, CCTV, guard shack, keycard access

Software Implementation (Agile Approach):

- Requirements gathering & backlog grooming
- Sprint-based development of Help Desk features
- Integration with existing user directory / ticketing platforms
- User acceptance testing (UAT)
- Training & onboarding materials
- Production deployment & post-launch support

Out of Scope

- Any additional cloud-based failover data centers (future phase)
 - Integration with third-party analytics/BI tools
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Key Stakeholders

- **Project Sponsor:** Olivia Carmichael – VP of IT Operations
 - **Program Manager:** Colten Bayles
 - **Construction Lead:** Marcus Hale – Sr. Site Superintendent
 - **Security Lead:** Tasha Freeman – Physical Security Director
 - **IT Infrastructure Architect:** David Cheng
 - **Product Owner (Software):** Amanda Ruiz
 - **Scrum Master:** TBD (Agile team lead)
 - **Dev/QA Team Leads, UX Designer, SME, etc.**
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High-Level Timeline

Phase	Duration	Start	End
Site Prep & Design Approval	2 months	Month 1	Month 2
Construction (Core Build)	6 months	Month 3	Month 8
DC Finishing + Testing	2 months	Month 9	Month 10
Software Implementation	6 months	Month 6	Month 11
Final Production Cutover	1 month buffer	Month 11	Month 12

Budget Estimate

- **Construction Budget:** \$5,000,000.00
 - **Software Budget:** \$650,000.00
 - **Total Estimate:** ~\$5,650,000.00
(Includes labor, hardware, licensing, risk reserves, and post-go-live support)
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Assumptions

- Regulatory permits will be secured within 60 days
 - Agile team can operate independently of physical space until deployment
 - Final QA/UAT requires physical data center to be live
 - No major weather or material delays during construction phase
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Dependencies

- UAT and final deployment dependent on physical data center completion
 - Networking infrastructure must be functional by Month 9 for system testing
 - Guard shack & CCTV must be operational before hardware delivery
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Risks

- Material delivery delays
- Licensing or procurement hurdles for software tools
- Physical security system lead times
- Team turnover during Agile sprint cycles

Approval Sign-Off

This charter defines the scope, objectives, and high-level roadmap of the Hybrid Infrastructure & IT Modernization Initiative. Approval of this document authorizes the project to proceed with detailed planning and execution.

Name	Title	Signature / Date
Olivia Carmichael	Project Sponsor	_____
Colten Bayles	Program Manager (PM)	_____
Amanda Ruiz	Product Owner (Software)	_____
Marcus Hale	Construction Lead	_____